

From Invisible to Irresistible.

Rebranding & o€ Growth Strategy : A Conceptual Brand Strategy Case Study

Solène is not the subject. Solène is the strategy demonstration.

This project illustrates the journey that can take a brand from being invisible to irresistible through the process of positioning, aesthetic, and authenticity.

Brand Strategy

Creative Direction

Social Media

Brand Management

Insight → Decision → Execution → Outcome

Portfolio Project • Conceptual Brand • Not Commercially Implemented

by Drashti Patel

Luxury sells feeling, not product.

Most fashion brand launches tend to fail not on account of poor quality products, but on account of weak identities.

The brands have no style, no proposition, and no voice.

When a fashion brand feels interchangeable, it becomes harder to notice and remember.

01

No Identity

Brand logo alterations, brand colors not consistent, style changes from post to post. There is no way the viewers can tell what to expect in their feeds.

02

No Consistency

Some posts make the product seem like luxury products, and others like budget ones. The company doesn't know which one it is, so the consumer doesn't either.

03

Selling Product

Post captions don't use aspirational language but only state the features offered by the product. The process becomes more important than anything else.

04

Empty Minimalism

White background without any text does not mean minimalist approach. Minimalism is when every element that makes it into the picture is meaningful.

For this conceptual case, the primary opportunity is not product redesign but a coherent brand system designed to feel established from launch.

"Quietly powerful."

Two concepts that will determine all subsequent decisions in this project.
Is this concept quietly powerful? Yes or no. This is exactly what positioning on an axis looks like.

Brand Aesthetic	Controlled minimalism + deep emotion. Not empty but deliberate. Everything that is included, needs to be there.
Consistency Rule	In everything we do: the feed, reels, ads, direct messages, packaging, every single thing. If it's out of place, it doesn't get published. Not empty but deliberate. Everything that is included, needs to be there.
Positioning	Elegant, controlled, quietly powerful. The brand doesn't make a proclamation; it exists as a certainty.
The 0€ Constraint	Used here as a test condition, not a proof standard. Organic performance can offer one signal of audience brand fit; paid campaigns would need separate objectives and measurement.

Positioning is not a tagline. Positioning is a decision filter. Everything in this project can be traced back to this axis.

The conceptual brand used for strategy illustration.

The Sovereign Archetype

She does not go with the flow. She creates the vibe even before she walks into the room. Dignified, timeless, effortless.

Colour: 8-tone tonal system

From Noir Doux to Ivoire : only warm neutral tones. Or Sable in case of a gold accent at one place per composition at maximum.

Typography pairing

Display font : Cormorant Garamond. Editorial weight. Body font : DM Sans. Clean, neutral, never competes.

Three logo versions

Wordmark, editorial with a tagline, monogram SL mark. Three usages, no overlap whatsoever.

Brand tagline

“Dignified. Always.” A promise that cannot be broken.



Full Brand Identity Board
[Full Brand Identity Board.pdf](#)

If you want to see the complete Brand Identity Board :
CLICK the link (Full_Brand_Identity_Board.pdf)

Why the name is a strategy, not just a label.

/ so-LEN /

French · Latin "sollemnis"

Solemn, sacred, ceremonial : dignity worn lightly.

01 The Mythology

Names create myths instantly. Who is Solène? This question is good. Just think about it: Céline, Sandro, Isabel. The name is the identity in the brand world.

02 The è Advantage

The accent speaks about European elegance even before reading the name. It is an asset in the visual sense. Tagline is unnecessary here.

03 The Rarity

Less common within the selected reference set. Its distinctive spelling and sound are intended to improve memorability; naming and trademark checks would still be required.

04 The Register

Name "Solène" is heavy with occasion. Ceremonial, yet delicate. Precisely what luxury brand needs to possess.

The palette is the positioning made visible.



ALWAYS

Noir Doux for the type on light backgrounds. Or Sable used once per composition. Ivoire not pure white. All background must belong to the tonal range.

NEVER

Saturated colors should never be used.
Pure white (#FFF) or pure black (#000). Three different colors in a single composition.

Tonal family, no saturation

All colors are muted and warm. Harmony throughout visual identity is automatically achieved. Any one color saturated will disrupt the register of all compositions it inhabits.

French naming system

Noir Doux, Brun Fumé, Or Sable – not just color codes. Assigning names to colors is a powerful decision that creates a vocabulary unique to Solène.

Or Sable: one accent only

Gold used once per composition maximum. The luxury is restraint. Gold always has significance. Otherwise, there is no signal left.

Full Colour Palette Board
[Full_Colour_Palette_Board.pdf](#)

If you want to see the complete Colour Palette Board :
CLICK the link (Full_Colour_Palette_Board.pdf)

More letter spacing than weight. The è carries everything the logo needs.

01 Three versions, three contexts

Wordmark primary → Website, packaging, press. Wordmark + editorial with tagline → Campaigns, emails, lookbooks. SL monogram → Labels, buttons, wax seal, app icon. No conflicts anywhere.

02 No icon, no emblem

For this concept, the wordmark leads and the SL monogram is used only in functional, small-scale applications. An additional pictorial emblem was excluded to preserve the brand's restrained visual language.

03 The è is non-negotiable

Always spelled with è, never e. This is the visual element that gives it the feeling of being European and unreachable and this is the very idea of it.

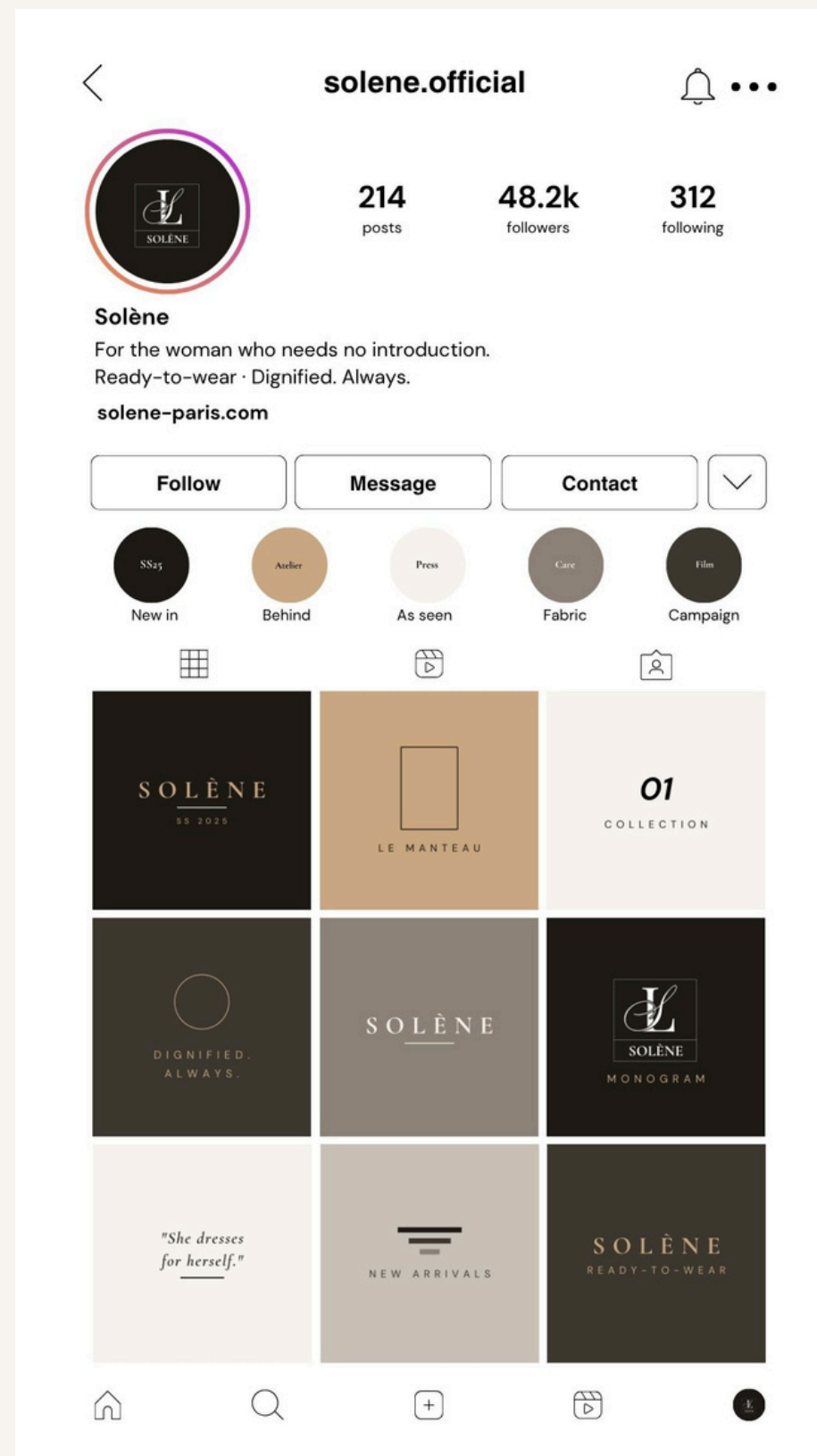
04 Wide tracking, single weight

Letter spacing does what bold type would have done. Space is treated as a matter. The weight of the type would make it seem too much effort – effort is the opposite of security in this context.

Full Logo System
[Full Logo System.pdf](#)

If you want to see the complete Logo System : all 3 logo versions, every colourway, and brand usage guidelines : CLICK the link (Full_Logo_System.pdf)

The brand, alive.



@solene.official

"For the woman who needs no introduction."

GRID LOGIC

Dark, mid, light. Three column functions: texture, editorial, text card.
The grid is an image as a whole before any post is ever opened.

BIO STRATEGY

"For the woman who needs no introduction." In one line. Setting the stage for the audience before presenting any product. Seven words to set the tone for the entire brand.

HIGHLIGHTS

SS25 · Atelier · As seen · Fabric · Campaign. Five ways to describe more about the brand than product inventory.

BEFORE POSTING

Each post is evaluated in the 3x3 frame before going live. Rhythm on the grid is not optional. If one square messes up the composition, the post is not ready yet.

The Silence Before.

SS 2025 · A campaign about the moment before a woman enters the room. (Conceptual campaign developed for this case study)

"She dressed in the dark. She knew every button."

ART DIRECTION

LIGHT

Single source. Raking light from the side. Long shadows.

SET

Empty interiors. Stone floors. Tall windows. No furniture.

MODEL

Still. No smiling. Eye contact or looking away. Never mid-motion.

GRADE

Desaturated warm. Lifted blacks. No crushed shadows.

CAMPAIGN COPY

Hero Line

"The silence before she enters the room is already her."

Secondary

"She doesn't dress to be seen. She dresses to feel complete."

Product Tone

"Cut from double-faced wool. Made to outlast the season."

Closing Line

"Dignified. Always."

VISUAL REFERENCES

Flemish Portraits

Luchino Visconti

Peter Lindbergh

Totème SS24

Agnès Varda

Full Campaign Moodboard
[Full_Campaign_Moodboard.pdf](#)

If you want to Deep-dive into the Campaign Moodboard — visual references, art direction, aesthetic inspiration, and creative vision : CLICK the link [Full_Campaign_Moodboard.pdf]

The 0€ constraint is not a limitation. It is the discipline.

Organic growth creates people who discovered you, selected you, and stuck around.
These followers may turn out to be future customers and are a better indication of audience-brand fit compared to only paid reach.

01 Content for Saves

"Save" is more representative of engagement compared to likes because saves mean that there's intention to return to the content again.

02 30-Minute Response Test

Reply all comments within 30 minutes. Voice note every story reply. These actions are generally associated with stronger engagement signals.

03 Community Seeding Test

Pilot 20–30 minutes per day engaging meaningfully with 10–15 aligned accounts. Review profile visits, relevant followers, and conversations after four weeks.

04 Hashtag Test

Begin by testing one branded hashtag, up to three niche-luxury hashtags, and up to three broader fashion hashtags. Compare non-follower reach, saves, and profile visits, then revise the mix monthly. Seven hashtags is the starting test condition, not a universal rule.

05 Collaboration Content

Collaborative Reels, Story Takeovers, Hashtag Swaps. Aesthetically similar is non-negotiable. Use an existing audience by being similar aesthetically.

06 Email from Day One

Bio → early access landing page. Editorial newsletter email only. Proposed test goals for this conceptual launch: 50 email subscribers by day 30 and 300 by day 90. These goals would be reassessed after establishing baseline traffic and conversion rates.

The Quiet Drop.

A seasonal launch is not a product announcement. It is the opening of a world.

WEEK 1	WEEK 2	WEEK 3	WEEK 4
The Teaser → Texture study Reel 60s : no product → Daily environment Stories : pure mood → Grid: abstract color palette composition → Caption: launch date. Just the date.	The Reveal → Hero collection Reel 45s — world first → 3 grid posts dropped within an hour → Countdown story — link in bio → Proposed execution: Direct Message personal preview to top 50 followers.	The Proof → Micro-influencer content drops → Brand story carousel — 10 slides → Reel: 3 ways to wear (45s) → UGC repost — personal acknowledgment	The Close → Final cinematic editorial Reel → '12 left.' Factual. Calm. Not panicked. → Campaign summary carousel → Community gratitude post — no product

12

Reels

6

Static Posts

2

Carousels

28+

Stories

From invisible to irresistible.

Sandro

→ More Accessible

Solène is strategically higher than Sandro in terms of perceived premium and positioning.

Isabel Marant

→ More Parisian edge

Solène is composed where Isabel is effortful.

Totême

→ Direct comparator

Solène's closest strategic reference point. Quieter, more ceremonial.

The Row

→ Aspirational ceiling

The long-term aspirational positioning anchor.

WHAT THIS BRAND WOULD BE POSITIONED TO DO

Drive a premium pricing approach via perceived value.

Make more appealing to visually compatible micro-influencers.

Set the stage for better visitor-to-followers conversion ratio.

Run a campaign that builds anticipation before a product is shown.

"Set a target goal of 300 e-mail sign-ups in 90 days."

Fill the void that exists between Sandro and Totême.

The thinking behind the work.

Controlled Minimalism

A demanding aesthetic system because every included element carries greater visual weight. Maximalism relies on volume, minimalism has no place to hide. Its adoption is an act of bravado.

Tonal palette, no saturation

All colors are dull and warm. Any saturated color ruins any composition it is a part of. Palette brings harmony by design.

Wordmark-led identity

For Solène, the wordmark is the primary identity, while the SL monogram is reserved for small-scale applications. Avoiding an additional pictorial emblem supports this project's controlled, editorial positioning; it is not presented as a universal rule of luxury.

"Dignified. Always."

An eternal commitment, not a seasonal term. It defines the brand's aesthetic regardless of the season or trend. It can't turn out to be a lie.

Optimise for Saves

It is believed that saves represent a better indicator of the content's value than likes. Designing with saves in mind requires resonating design, not game playing.

"The Silence Before"

Campaign title that provides emotional context before the product is even launched. Aspiration without commerce. The feeling precedes the thing.

Accompanying PDFs

PDF

Full Brand Identity Board

[Full Brand Identity Board.pdf](#)

PDF

Full Colour Palette Board

[Full Colour Palette Board.pdf](#)

PDF

Full Logo System

[Full Logo System.pdf](#)

PDF

Full Campaign Moodboard

[Full Campaign Moodboard.pdf](#)

"This project demonstrates
end-to-end brand thinking :
from diagnosis to identity
to activation.

Every decision is strategic,
documented, and defensible."

Conceptual Strategy Project • Created for Portfolio Purposes • Not Commercially Implemented

SOLÈNE
DIGNIFIED . ALWAYS